

# Lesson 2: Standards of Critical Thinking

Dr. Mayada Mahmoud



# Lesson 2: Standards of Critical Thinking

- **Lesson Objectives:**

- ➤ Recognize the important intellectual standards of critical thinking.
- **Activity # 2:** *Dear learners, do you know any standard of critical thinking? How do you identify good critical thinking from bad critical thinking? What basic standards do you think critical thinking should meet?*

# Standards of Critical Thinking

- Not every thinking is critical.
- To identify a critical thinking from the uncritical, we refer to some standards.
- **The intellectual standards are**
  1. Clarity ,
  2. Accuracy ,
  3. Precision ,
  4. Relevance ,
  5. Depth,
  6. Breadth ,
  7. logic, and
  8. Significance
  9. fairness.



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)



## 1. Clarity:

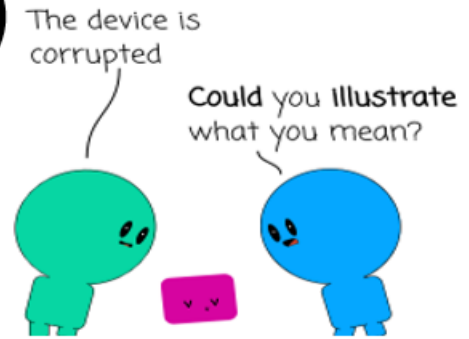
Is to be free from confusion or to remove obscurities.

- Clarity is a “gateway” standard.
- If a statement is unclear, one cannot determine whether it is accurate or relevant.
- For example:
- Here is an unclear question: *“What can be done about the education system in America?”*
- A clearer question : *“What can educators do to ensure that students learn the skills and abilities which help them understand the world?”*

# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## Questions that focus on clarity in thinking include:

- Could you elaborate on that point? or Do I need to elaborate on that point?
- Could you express that point in another way? Can I express that point differently?
- Could you give me an illustration? or Should I give an illustration?
- Could you give me an example? or Should I provide an example?
- Let me state in my own words what I think you just said. Am I clear about your meaning?
- I hear you saying “\_\_\_\_.” Am I hearing you correctly, or have I misunderstood you?



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 2. Accuracy:

**Free from errors, mistakes or distortions; true, correct and accurate.**

- A statement can be clear but not accurate, as in “Most dogs weigh more than 300 pounds.”
- Questions that focus on accuracy in thinking include:
  - How could I check that to see if it is true?
  - How could I verify these facts?
  - Can I trust the accuracy of these data given the source from which they come?



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

DETAILS

## 3. Precision:

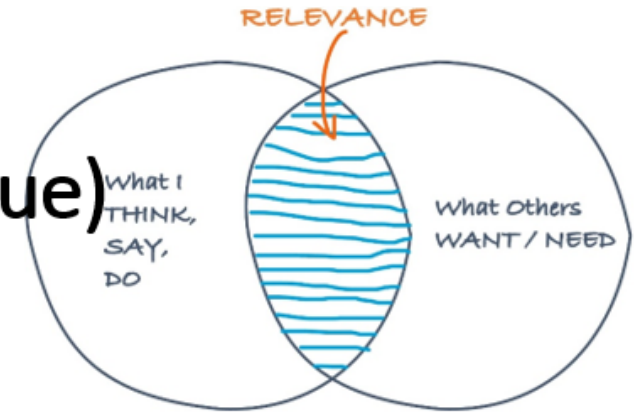
### The necessary level of detail, specific.

- A statement can be both clear and accurate, but not precise, as in “*Jack is overweight.*” (*One doesn’t know how overweight Jack is, one pound or 500 pounds.*)
- Questions that focus on precision in thinking include
  - Could you give me more details about that?
  - Could you be more specific?
  - Could you be more exact?





# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)



## 4.Relevance:

Relating to the matter at hand; implies a close logical relationship with, and importance to, the matter under consideration.

- **For example**, students often think that the amount of effort they put into a course should be used in raising their grade in a course. Often, however, **“effort” does not measure the quality of student learning**, but, effort is irrelevant to their appropriate grade.
- **Questions that focus on relevance in thinking include:**
  - I don't see how what you said bears on the question. Could you show me how it is relevant?
  - Could you explain the connection between your question and the question we are addressing?
  - How does this idea relate to this other idea?
  - How does your question relate to the issue at hand?



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 5. Depth:

Containing complexities and multiple interrelationships, implies thinking through the many variables in the situation, context, idea, or question.

- Questions that focus on depth in thinking include:
  - What factors make this difficult?
  - What are some of the complexities of this question?
  - What are some of the difficulties we need to deal with?

DEPTH \_



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 6. Breadth:

Encompassing multiple viewpoints, comprehensive in view, wide ranging and broad-open minded in perspective.

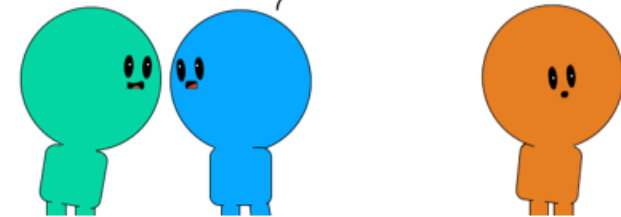
- Questions that focus on breadth in thinking include:

- What points of view are relevant to this issue?
- What relevant points of view have I ignored thus far?
- Do we need to look at this from another perspective?
- Do we need to consider another point of view?
- Do we need to look at this in other ways?

BREADTH \_

The orange  
hates us

Do we need to look at this  
from **another perspective**?  
Maybe we just need to talk  
with the orange



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 7. Logic:

**The parts that make sense together, no contradictions; in keeping with the reasonability.**

When the combination of thoughts is mutually supporting and makes sense in combination, the thinking is logical.

- **Questions that focus on logic include**

- Does all this fit together logically?
- Does this really make sense?
- Does your first paragraph fit in with your last one?
- Does what you say follow from the evidence?



# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 8. Significance:

- Concentrate on the most important information (relevant to the issue) and take into account the most important ideas or concepts.
- Questions that focus on significance include:
  - What is the most significant information in this issue?
  - How is that fact important in context?
  - Which of these questions is the most significant?
  - Which of these ideas or concepts is the most important?
  - Is this the central idea to focus on?



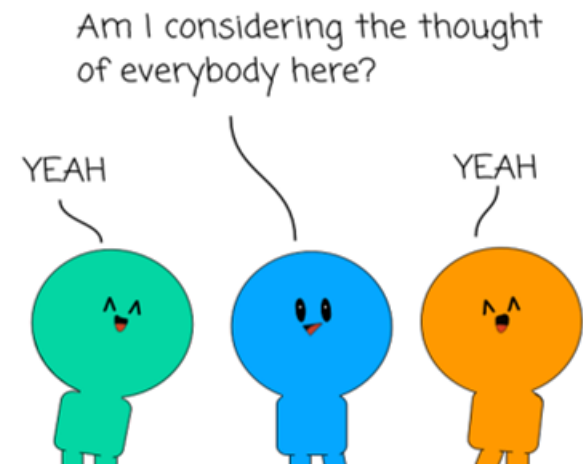
# Standards of Critical Thinking (continue)

## 9. Fairness:

Free from bias, dishonesty, favoritism, selfish-interest, deception or injustice.

- Because everyone tends to be biased in favor of their own viewpoint, it is important to keep the intellectual standard of fairness
- Questions that focus on fairness include:
  - Am I taking into account the thinking of others?
  - Are these laws justifiable and ethical, or do they violate someone's rights?

FAIRNESS ..



# Critical Thinking Standards

Clarity

Accuracy

Precision

Relevance

Depth

Breadth

Logic

Fairness